

Long hair is always tied back in a bun.

Male dancers need to be strong. They have to lift ballerinas high up in the air.

This is ballet, too!

During this century some very adventurous ballets have been performed. These modern ballets use many of the classic steps, but often have no story. The imaginatively dressed dancers simply express a mood.

Ballerinas sew on their own ribbons.

The ballerina keeps her foot pointed.

The leg is held very still and straight.

A female ballet dancer is called a ballerina.

Dancing on tiptoes makes the ballerina's legs look longer and more graceful.

Ballerinas put cotton wool inside their shoes so their toes don't hurt.

Ballet dancers wear tights.

Ballet shoes

To dance on tiptoe, or *en pointe*, ballerinas wear special satin slippers with stiffened toes. Girls have to be at least twelve years old before their feet are strong enough to dance like this.

Male dancers' shoes do not have stiffened toes.

